

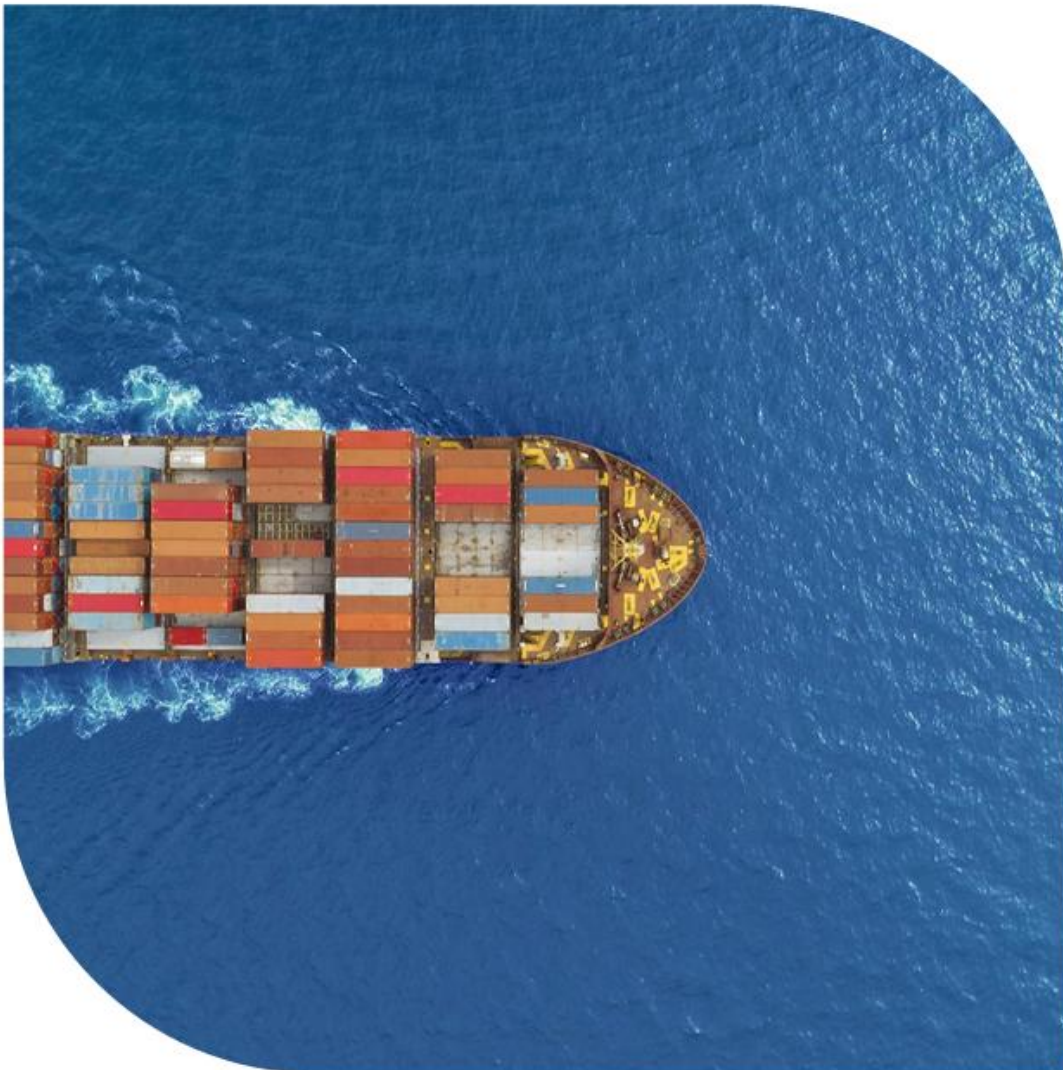


Australian Government
Department of Agriculture,
Fisheries and Forestry

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Australian biofouling management requirements for commercial vessels

Version 4



Proactive biofouling management options

A vessel operator that reports they can demonstrate compliance with a proactive biofouling management option must be able to satisfy the required documentary evidence in this section.

Option 1: Biofouling management plan and record book

If you report that the vessel has implemented an effective biofouling management plan and record book, the following documents must be available on request:

- Biofouling management plan (BFMP) that meets the minimum standards set out in [Appendix A](#).
- Biofouling record book (BFRB) that meets the minimum standards set out in [Appendix A](#).

A biofouling management plan and record book must meet the departments minimum standards to satisfy the requirements of option 1.

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Option 2: Vessel cleaned of all biofouling within 30 days prior to arrival

If you report that the vessel has been cleaned of all biofouling within 30 days prior to arrival in Australian territorial seas, the following documents must be available on request:

- cleaning report that meets the minimum standard set out in [Appendix B](#).
- supporting photographs and/or video that meets the minimum standard set out in [Appendix B](#).

A cleaning report and supporting evidence must meet the department's minimum standards to satisfy the requirements of proactive biofouling management option 2.

Option 3: Alternative biofouling management method pre-approved by the department

If you report that the vessel has an alternative biofouling management method, it must be pre-approved by the department and the following documents must be available on request:

- department issued written approval, specific to the vessel and voyage
- any required documents as specified in the department issued approval.

Approval of the alternative biofouling management method must be obtained from the department prior to arrival to meet the requirements of proactive biofouling management option 3.

Obtaining pre-approval

The department will consider applications for an alternative biofouling management method if the vessel operator can provide:

- a proposed alternative method that appropriately manages the biosecurity risk associated with the vessel's biofouling
- sufficient evidence to substantiate the proposal.

Applications for an alternative biofouling management method must include:

- a completed and signed application form
- the most recent in-water inspection and cleaning reports
- evidence to support your application.

The application must be submitted to biofouling@aff.gov.au no later than 30 days prior to arrival in Australian territorial seas. The department may request further information to process the application. Email biofouling@aff.gov.au to obtain an application form.

Vessel operators unable to demonstrate proactive management

A vessel operator that cannot demonstrate proactive biofouling management practices using one of the 3 accepted management options will be required to provide additional information in their pre-arrival report.



Vessels

CRMS Vessels

13 October 2023

Excludes biosecurity risks managed by:

International Convention for the Control and Management of Ships' Ballast Water and Sediments

Please refer to this document for further details.

Acceptable measures for ensuring a vessel has a 'clean hull'

- (3) Operators or the person in charge of a vessel must provide evidence for one of the following options to show compliance with Schedule 4.
- a) **Continual maintenance using best practice:** This includes application of antifouling coatings, operation of marine growth prevention systems and in-water inspections with biofouling removal as required. This measure is suitable for short-stay vessels only.
 - b) **Clean before arrival:** Inspect and if required, remove all biofouling found from all parts of the hull, including niche areas, less than 30 days before arrival to New Zealand.
 - c) **Clean out of water on arrival:** Have a booking at a MPI approved haul-out facility to remove biofouling and enter this facility within 24 hours of arrival to New Zealand. Once in the facility, all biofouling from all parts of the hull, including niche areas are removed.
 - d) **Treat on arrival:** All available approved treatments are listed in [Approved Biosecurity Treatments](#) (MPI-STD-ABTRT). This excludes the removal of biofouling in an approved haul-out facility.

Guidance

- Following the IMO Biofouling Guidelines is an example of best practice.

Part 2: Specific requirements

2.1 Short-stay vessels

- (1) This part applies to all vessels that enter New Zealand territory where the operator or person in charge of a vessel has given notice under part 1.4 that the vessel will:
- a) only visit ports designated as places of first arrival with travel via the most direct route practical; and
 - b) remain in New Zealand territory for a maximum voyage of 28 consecutive days from time of entry into New Zealand territory; and
 - c) arrive in New Zealand with a 'clean hull'. A hull is considered to be a 'clean hull' when no biofouling of live organisms is present other than those within the thresholds in Table 1 of Schedule 4.

Guidance

- If after arrival an operator or person in charge of a vessel wants to extend a vessel's stay past 28 days or visit places that are not places of first arrival, they must contact MPI as soon as possible and make arrangements for the vessel to meet the requirements for long-stay vessels.
- All short-stay vessels are subject to 1.5(4) at all times. This includes all equipment used overboard and personal belongings until they have been issued clearance under the Biosecurity Act 1993.

2.2 Long-stay vessels and other vessels

- (1) This part applies if an operator or person in charge of a vessel gives notice under part 1.4 that the vessel will:
- a) remain in New Zealand territory for 29 consecutive days or longer; or
 - b) visit areas other than places of first arrival.
- (2) The operator or person in charge of the vessel must obtain written confirmation from an inspector at a place of first arrival that the vessel meets the requirements in section 2.2(2)(a), 2.2(2)(b) and 2.2(2)(c). This must be done before the vessel leaves the place of first arrival or otherwise within 28 consecutive days of entering New Zealand territory.
- a) The vessel is free of regulated pests and biosecurity contamination.
 - b) Any risk goods have either:
 - i) been removed from the vessel through an approved process; or
 - ii) received biosecurity clearance under the Act.
 - c) The vessel has a 'clean hull'. That is, no biofouling of live organisms is present other than those within the thresholds in Table 2 of Schedule 4.

2.3 Cruise vessels

- (1) The operator or person in charge of a cruise vessel must ensure that the cruise vessel either:
- complies with long-stay requirements set out in Clause 2.2; or
 - operates under an MPI-approved system to manage topside and biofouling risk.

Guidance

- Clause 2.3 is not suitable for chartered yachts. For more information on yachts, visit the MPI website.
- Cruise vessels with specific itineraries may be able to achieve biofouling compliance using short-stay biofouling measures however, this would be incorporated into an MPI-approved system for the whole vessel's biosecurity management.
- Due to the high volumes of risk goods found on board cruise vessels (i.e. food, plants, personal effects), using short-stay measures to manage topside risk is not an appropriate method for proving compliance.

Schedule 4: Biofouling thresholds

Table 1: Biofouling threshold for short-stay vessels

Hull part	Allowable biofouling
All hull surfaces	Slime layer Goose barnacles
Wind and water line	Green algae growth of unrestricted cover, no more than 50 mm in frond, filament or beard length Brown and red algal growth no more than 4 mm in length Incidental (maximum of 1%) coverage of tubeworms, bryozoans and/or barnacles, occurring as isolated individuals or small clusters
Hull area	Algal growth occurring as: - no more than 4 mm in length; and - continuous strips and/or patches of no more than 50 mm in width Incidental (maximum of 1%) coverage of tubeworms, bryozoans and/or barnacles, occurring as isolated individuals or small clusters that have no algal overgrowth
Niche areas	Algal growth occurring as: - no more than 4 mm in length; and - continuous strips and/or patches of no more than 50 mm in width Scattered (maximum of 5%) coverage of tubeworms, bryozoans and/or barnacles, occurring as widely spaced individuals and/or infrequent, patchy clusters that have no algal overgrowth

Table 2: Biofouling threshold for long-stay vessels

Hull part	Allowable biofouling
All hull surfaces	Slime layer Goose barnacles